With this configuration in place (and with the todo shut off), our RuboCop tells us there are four problems:

- It wants us to set a config parameter for rubygems_mfa_required in the .gemspec, which sets multi-factor security on the gem itself.
- The target ruby in RuboCop is different from the Ruby version specified in the .gemspec.
- There's a single-quote string in the .gemspec.
- It wants us to freeze the constant DEFAULT_DICTIONARY = "/usr/share/dict/words".

Most of the problems are in the .gemspec. We can now fix these either by updating the configuration or by running rubocop -a to auto correct, or rubocop -A to auto correct and include some cops that might be unsafe to auto correct. Using rubocop -A will correct all but the first issue.

You can also disable a cop inline in your file with a magic comment: # rubocop/disable Style/WordArray or whatever the name of the cop you want to disable is. If the comment comes at the end of a line, it merely disables for that line. If it stands on its own, it disables until the end of the file or a matching # rubocop/enable comment, whichever comes first. This is sometimes useful, but again is something you want to use sparingly. Frequent use of disabling RuboCop suggests that the settings you have aren't quite right.

There's more to RuboCop, including a lot of extensions, and you can write your own cops to identify whatever Ruby style options you want. See the RuboCop documentation[3] for more information.

Using Standard

RuboCop is powerful, but also quite complicated. If we're being honest, we don't like all the defaults. As a result, our typical project winds up with a long configuration file that's a bit unwieldy and continually subject to argument. If only somebody would come up with a more consensus-based Ruby style-checker.

Enter Standard,[4] a default configuration of RuboCop created by Justin Searls that is minimally configurable and conforms to a small, but commonly used, set of rules.

What rules? You can see the entire list in Standard's RuboCop setup, but the gist is very similar to the common rules we set out in the first part of this chapter:

- Two-space indentation
- Double-quoted strings
- No hash rockets for symbol hash keys
- Spaces inside curly braces for blocks and not for hashes
- Braces for single line blocks (Standard does not specify how you handle multiline blocks)

Installing Standard just requires putting gem "standard" in your gemfile. You don't need a configuration.

To run Standard, just enter standardrb from the command line and you'll get RuboCop output. Using standardrb --fix will autocorrect errors, and using standardrb --generate-todo will create a .standard_todo.yml file just like the todo file RuboCop generates.

3. https://docs.rubocop.org
4. https://github.com/testdouble/standard